

1. Birth of the Christian kingdoms (8th-10th centuries)

1.1 The resistance cores

- **Northern peninsula:** The only area not occupied by Muslims in 711.
- **Cantabrian Core:**
 - **Covadonga (722):** Pelayo begins the resistance.
 - **Evolution:** Kingdom of Asturias → Kingdom of León (910).
 - **Castile:** Border county of León named for its numerous **castles**.
- **Pyrenean Core:**
 - **Marca Hispánica:** Frontier created by Charlemagne.
 - **Independence (9th-10th centuries):** The kingdoms of Pamplona (Navarre), Aragon and Catalan counties are born.

1.1.1 Conquest or Reconquista?

- **Reconquista:** The idea that Christians recover "their" kingdom (that of the Visigoths).
- **Reality:** A very slow process (8 centuries) with long periods of **peace, pacts, and alliances** between both sides. It was not a continuous war.

1.2 Advance to the Duero (9th-10th centuries)

- **Objective:** The Duero River becomes the natural border.
- **Repopulators:** Peasants from the north and **Mozarabs** (Christians who lived in al-Andalus).
- **Independence of Castile:** Count **Fernán González** achieves Castile's autonomy from León.
- **Final setback:** At the end of the 10th century, the Muslim general **Al-Mansur** plundered the north and forced the Christians to pay tribute.

2. Christian conquest between the 11th and 13th centuries

2.1 Consolidation of the four great kingdoms

- **Castile and León:** Upon the death of Sancho III, the struggles between the heirs gave rise to the kingdoms of Castile and León. They were definitively united in **1230** under Ferdinand III, the Saint (Crown of Castile).
- **Aragon:** In 1137 the **Crown of Aragon was born** after the union of Petronila of Aragon and Ramon Berenguer IV (count of Barcelona).
- **Portugal:** It became independent from León in the 12th century and advanced south on its own.

- **Navarre:** It is left without a Muslim border and orients its policy towards France.

2.2 Tagus and Ebro Valleys (1031-1150)

- **Weakness of al-Andalus:** It is divided into **Taifas** . Christians collect **parias** (peace taxes).
- **Military milestones:**
 - **Toledo (1085):** With Alfonso VI, Castile reaches the Tagus River.
 - **Zaragoza (1118):** Aragon dominates the Ebro.
 - **Lisbon (1147):** Portugal advances to the west.
- **Brake:** The arrival of the Almoravids and Almohads during the 12th century from Africa temporarily halted the Christian advance.

2.3 The great advance of the 13th century

- **Las Navas de Tolosa (1212):** Key battle. A Christian coalition defeats the Almohads and opens the way to the south.
- **Final expansion:**
 - **Castile:** Conquers the Guadalquivir Valley (Seville, Cordoba) and Murcia.
 - **Aragon:** James I conquers **Valencia** and **the Balearic Islands** .
 - **Portugal:** Its conquest of the Algarve ends (1249).
- **End of the century:** Only the **Nasrid Kingdom of Granada** resists .

3. Social transformations of territorial expansion

3.1 The repopulation of the territory

- **Objective:** To attract people to the south to control and defend the conquered areas.
- **Repopulation formulas:**
 - **8th-10th centuries (Presura):** Spontaneous occupation of free lands by peasants, monks or nobles (North of the Duero).
 - **11th-12th centuries (Fueros):** The king grants privileges and own laws (**Cartas Puebla**) to attract people to border cities (Tagus Valley).
 - **13th Century (Latifundia):** Large plots of land given to the **Nobility, Church and Military Orders** for their help in the war (South of the Tagus).

3.2 The Mudejar minority

- **Definition:** Muslims living in Christian territory after the conquest.
- **Legal status:** They were allowed to keep their religion and laws, but they paid **more taxes** .

- They lived segregated in their own neighborhoods (**moorish quarters**).
- **Economics and Art:**
 - They worked in agriculture and in crafts (construction).
 - **Mudejar Art:** A unique style that blends Christianity with Muslim techniques and materials (brick, plaster, wood).

4. Conquest and repopulation of the Valencian territory

4.1 The creation of the Kingdom of Valencia

- **Jaime I's impetus:** He takes advantage of the Almohad crisis caused by the defeat at Las Navas de Tolosa to expand towards the Mediterranean.
- **Supporters:** Nobles (sought land), bourgeoisie (markets) and Church (religion).
- **Conquest phases:** A fast process with few battles (many pacts).
 - **1232:** Morella and Burriana.
 - **1238:** City of Valencia.
- **Borders:** They are set with Castile through the treaties of **Almizra** (1244) and **Torrellas** (1304), finally incorporating Alicante and Elche.

4.2 The distribution and the new settlers

- **The Division:** The lands are divided according to the support received in the war. The nobles receive large estates, and the king controls the cities and the coast.
- **The Fueros (1261):** Laws and privileges created by James I for the new kingdom.
- **Origin of the settlers: Catalans** on the coast.
 - **Aragonese** in the interior.
- **Economic model:** Small family farms with irrigated and dryland farming.

4.2.1 The Mudejar communities

- **Expulsion:** Muslims lose their best orchards on the coast.
- **Destination:** They are displaced to poorer and more mountainous inland areas.
- **In the cities:** In centers like Valencia or Xàtiva, they work in crafts, but are forced to live in **Moorish quarters** .

5. The importance of the Camino de Santiago

5.1 The origin of the place

- **The discovery:** In the 9th century, a supposed tomb attributed to the apostle James (Compostela = "field of stars") was found in Galicia .
- **First impulse:** King Alfonso II of Asturias builds the first church to protect the relics and promote worship.

5.2 Pilgrimages

- **Motivations:**
 - **Religious:** To venerate the relics of the apostle.
 - **Promises:** To ask for or give thanks for health cures.
 - **Penances:** To purify the soul after having committed serious sins.
- **What was the journey like?** It was done on foot, in a group (for safety) and generally in spring/summer.
 - **Symbol:** The **shell** sewn onto clothing identified the pilgrim.
 - **The goal:** The Cathedral of Santiago, the Pórtico de la Gloria and the use of the **botafumeiro** to purify the atmosphere before the crowd.

5.3 Consequences of the Path

- **Economic:** Renaissance of cities (Burgos, León, Logroño...) thanks to markets, fairs, hospitals and hostels for pilgrims.
- **Cultural:** It was the gateway to the Peninsula for European ideas and the **Romanesque and Gothic artistic styles** .
- **Social:** Massive exchange of customs and people throughout Europe that turned the Camino into a vibrant cultural hub to this day.

6. Peninsular Romanesque art (11th and 12th centuries)

6.1 Architecture: three main variants

- **French Romanesque:** Linked to the Camino de Santiago.
 - **Features:** Floor plans with 1 or 3 naves with a barrel vault.
 - **Examples:** Santiago Cathedral and San Martín de Frómista.
- **Lombard Romanesque:** Typical of northern Catalonia and Aragon.
 - **Features:** Small churches, tall bell towers and exterior blind arch decoration.
 - **Examples:** Churches of Taüll and Monastery of Ripoll.
- **Mudejar Romanesque:** A blend of Christian techniques with Muslim materials.
 - **Features:** Use of **brick** and blind arcades in the walls.
 - **Areas:** Castile, León and Aragon.

6.2 Sculpture: stone and wood

- **Location:** It is concentrated on the **portals** (facades) and on the **capitals** of the columns.
- **Themes:** Christ in Majesty (Pantocrator), the Virgin with Child and fantastic animals.
- **Carvings:** Polychrome wooden sculptures (bright colors) of crucified Christs.
- **Key works:** Pórtico de la Gloria (Santiago) and cloister of Silos.

6.3 Painting: color on the walls

- **Technique:** **Fresco** predominates (painting on a wet wall).
- **Style:** Rigid (hieratic) figures, primary colors and very marked drawing (black outlines).
- **Location:** It mainly decorates the **apses** (headboards) of churches.
- **Examples:** San Clemente de Taüll (Lleida) and Pantheon of San Isidoro de León.

Questions

Topic: Christian Kingdoms | 2nd year of ESO (Secondary Education)

1.1 The resistance cores

Which area of the Peninsula was not occupied by the Muslims in 711 and what centers of Christian resistance emerged there?

1.1.2 Conquest or Reconquista?

What does the term "Reconquista" mean and why wasn't it a continuous war?

1.2 Advance to the Duero

Who repopulated the lands up to the Duero River and why was that river important?

2.1 Consolidation of the four great kingdoms

What were the four great Christian kingdoms and how were they formed?

2.2 Tagus and Ebro Valleys

Why did the Christians advance through the valleys of the Tagus and the Ebro?

2.3 The great advance of the 13th century

What was the significance of the Battle of Las Navas de Tolosa?

3.1 The repopulation of the territory

What forms of repopulation were used during the Christian expansion?

3.2 The Mudejar minority

Who were the Mudéjars and how did they live in the Christian kingdoms?

4.1 The creation of the Kingdom of Valencia

How did the conquest of the Valencian territory take place?

4.2 The distribution and the new settlers

How were the lands divided after the conquest and where did the settlers come from?

4.2.1 The Mudejar communities

What happened to the Mudéjars after the Valencian conquest?

5.1 The origin of the Camino de Santiago

How did the Camino de Santiago originate?

5.2 Pilgrimages

Why did the pilgrims make the Camino and how did they travel?

5.3 Consequences of the Path

What were the consequences of the Camino de Santiago?

6.1 Romanesque architecture

What are the main characteristics of Romanesque architecture?

6.2 Romanesque Sculpture

Where is Romanesque sculpture located and what themes does it represent?

6.3 Romanesque painting

What are the characteristics of Romanesque painting?